+

Everyday Holiness

Week 6 · Marriage & Parenting Through Temperament

This is the last week -- and it lands everything you have learned in the place it matters most: the people you actually live with. It is easy to be holy alone in a quiet chapel. It is much harder at 5pm with a toddler melting down. That is where the roots actually go down. Not in the chapel -- in the kitchen.

WE LOVE THE WAY WE WANT TO BE LOVED

Here is what quietly wrecks a lot of marriages, and almost nobody names it: we love people the way WE want to be loved, not the way THEY need to be loved. So you give your spouse what would fill you, and cannot understand why it does not land. It is not a lack of love. It is a translation problem. Your temperament shapes how you give love and how you need to receive it -- and so does theirs.

+ *"Love is patient, love is kind. It does not insist on its own way." -- 1 Corinthians 13:4-5*

LOVING ACROSS A TEMPERAMENT LINE

Watch what your spouse complains about -- it is usually the love they are starving for. Watch what they freely give -- people give what they most want to receive. And here is the holy part: loving someone the way THEY need, when it does not come naturally to you and you get no natural reward for it, is a daily death to self. That is not a marriage problem. That is the exact shape of the Cross in your own home.

WEEK 6 *D -- Dwelling*

+ *"Remain in me, as I also remain in you." -- John 15:4*

Dwelling is the destination of the whole model -- abiding, remaining, resting in Christ. And it turns out Dwelling is not a quiet chapel far from your life. It is right in the middle of it: in the marriage, with the children, at 5pm on a Tuesday. This week you practice abiding in Him precisely where your life is loudest.

MORNING REFLECTION · WEEK 6

How do you naturally give love -- what does love look like when it flows out of you easily?

How does the person closest to you actually need to receive love? What do they complain about or ask for?

Where are you handing them your language instead of theirs -- loving hard, and still missing each other?

"The roots do not go down in the chapel. They go down in the kitchen."

YOUR FAULT COMES HOME WITH YOU

Your predominant fault does not stay at work. It is most active with the people you love most -- because they are the ones safe enough to see your worst self. This is not a reason for shame; it is why your home is your greatest school of holiness. Your spouse is not the obstacle to your holiness. He is the classroom. And so is the child who knows exactly which button to press.

Where is your fault most active at home -- with whom, and in what recurring moment?

SEEING YOUR CHILD'S TEMPERAMENT

Understanding your child's temperament is not parenting psychology. It is learning to see the specific image of God in the specific person He handed you. The strong-willed child may be a leader God is forming -- shape the fire without putting it out. The sensitive one is not too much -- that may be a deep interior life and a tender conscience. You are not raising a generic child. You are forming this one, on purpose.

What are you noticing about your child's temperament? What does this specific child need from you?

LOVE IS A DECISION, RENEWED DAILY

You already know this from the model: the Turn does not wait for the feeling. Marriage and motherhood are that same truth, lived with the people closest to you. On the days you do not feel loving -- and there will be many -- you love anyway, one small faithful choice at a time. And the mercy in it: love practiced becomes love felt far more reliably than the other way around.

LOOKING BACK · SIX WEEKS

What is the most significant thing God said to you across these six weeks? (Not the most useful -- the most significant.)

PRACTICES TO KEEP

Which practices have become yours -- the Rosary, the Examen, the Bridge Thought, closing the laptop, praying by name, running one moment through the model? Circle what stays. You do not need all of it forever. You need the few that keep you rooted.

FINAL BRIDGE THOUGHT · WEEK 6

I am rooted and built up in Him. My home is where holiness grows -- not away from the ordinary, but straight through the heart of it.

+ *"Rooted and built up in him, and established in the faith." -- Colossians 2:7*

You are rooted. And you are known. You always were -- now you know it.